

Figure 1: Ext2 volume manager

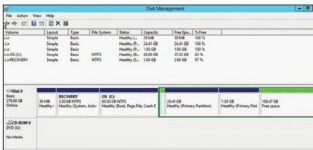


Figure 2: Ext2 IFS

Figure 1 shows the Linux partition after assigning a drive letter. The Service Management feature of Ext2Fsd will enable you to view the current status of Ext2Fsd service which need to start it manually. It also provides the option to set all volumes to be loaded in 'read-only' mode or read/write mode. Ext2Fsd provides limited Ext4 support and by default, it will load the file systems in read-only mode.

Ext2 IFS* (Installable File System): Ext2 IFS provides Windows with full access to Linux Ext2/Ext3 volumes. It installs a pure kernel mode file system driver, Ext2fs.sys, which actually extends the Windows operating system to include the Ext2 file system. You can view the Linux partition listed in the disk management as shown in Figure 2. This tool also adds the 'IFS drives' item to the control panel from where you can assign a drive letter to Linux partitions.

*On Win8 onwards, Ext2 Volume manager and Ext2 IFS need to be run with *Compatibility mode* enabled.

Tools used for 'read only' access to the Linux partition

Explore2fs: This is a GUI explorer tool for accessing Ext2 and Ext3 file systems. It runs under all versions of Windows and can read almost any Ext2 and Ext3 file system. You can save the content on your Windows partitions to make any changes to the files as shown in Figure 3.

DiskInternals Linux reader: This runs under Windows and

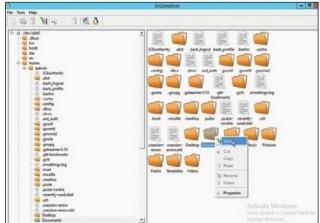


Figure 3: Explore2fs

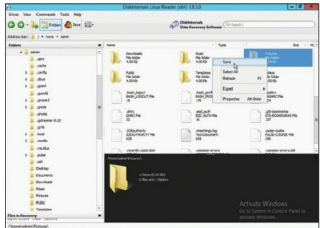


Figure 4: DiskInternals Linux reader

allows you to access Ext2/Ext3/Ext4 Linux files. It provides read-only access to the Linux partition and does not allow you to make changes in file system partitions. Also, it uses Windows Explorer to view and extract files/data. Figure 4 shows its usage.

The tools listed are the ones that we have used and found very useful in dual boot scenarios. There are many more tools available on the Internet, which can be used for accessing Linux partitions from Windows, but they may not be compatible with the latest Windows OS. **END**

References

You can get the above-mentioned tools from the following locations:

- [1] Ext2fsd: <http://sourceforge.net/projects/ext2fsd/>
- [2] Ext2IFS: <http://www.fs-driver.org/index.html>
- [3] Ext2read: <http://sourceforge.net/projects/ext2read/>
- [4] Explore2fs: <http://www.chysocme.net/explore2fs>

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